

PAGE 1 (SINGLE SPLASH)

EXT. ENTRANCE TO KELLERMAN INSTITUTE - DAY

All the subjects stand back to camera in front of the entrance to the ultra-high-tech, architecturally profound Institute. SOK insignia on a huge metal door.

TEXT: "*KELLERMAN INSTITUTE. Does not, nor will ever, appear on any Google Map or Earth searches. Private land held by a blind trust. Brain-child of Dr. Jeremiah Kellerman. Neuroscientist. Billionaire. Source of wealth unknown. Never photographed.*"

EMILE HAVERSTON stands at the entrance in front of everyone.

HAVERSTON

You all have questions. Hold them for now. I cannot offer you any guarantees of success in our program. Only you know what you're truly capable of. Paula?

PAGE 2 (FOUR PANEL)

1. CLOSE UP ON HAVERSTON - CONTINUOUS

A woman in her 40s stands next to him. Severe features. No-nonsense.

HAVERSTON

My Chief Clinical Officer, Dr. Paula Kurtz.

KURTZ

Welcome everyone. I look forward to killing with you.

2. SAME SCENE, PULL OUT FURTHER

Six very muscular men in security-type outfits join the group.

HAVERSTON

Each of you will be assigned your own security officer. We're short on staff, so we ask that you please not kill them...

3. REACTION THREE SUBJECTS

QUENTIN LAROCHE grins menacingly.

QUENTIN

...At least for now.

YAN grins provocatively.

YAN
Can we...play with them a little?

ASTRID, grinning at YAN.

ASTRID
I like you already.

4. ALL 6 SUBJECTS IN FRAME

Speaking amongst themselves as KURTZ and HAVERSTON walk away.

SAMARA
None of this feels right.

BRANDON
Was it supposed to?

CRYUS
Part of the appeal, right?

PAGE 3-4 (DOUBLE SPLASH) - FIVE PANELS

1. INT. INSIDE INSTITUTE (BIG PANEL)

HAVERSTON and KURTZ walks everyone through the high-tech lobby.

HAVERSTON
It took us considerable time and effort to find and recruit all of you. Please don't disappoint us.

KURTZ
We keep strict schedules. No exceptions or excuses will be tolerated.

2. LONG CORRIDOR WITH THREE DOORS ON EACH SIDE

Tour continues...

HAVERSTON
Your living quarters. We lock down promptly at 8pm.

KURTZ
For your protection.

3.C/U ON HAVERSTON - CONTINUOUS

HAVERSTON

Some of you may want to have sex
with one another. This will lead to
your immediate expulsion. Some of
you may want to kill one another.
This will lead to your immediate
liquidation.

4. SUBJECTS REACTION

CYRUS

Liquidation, as in...

BRANDON

We're toast, big guy.

YAN

So I can't fuck anyone, I can't kill
anyone, even though I'd like to
fucking kill everyone - is that it?

SAMARA

God I love this place already.

5. C/U ON BRANDON - CONTINUOUS

BRANDON

Enough of this dog and pony bullshit.
When do we eat?

PAGE 5 (THREE PANEL)

1. DINING HALL (BIG TOP PANEL)

An ornate dining room. Baroque gothic horror meets Frank
Lloyd Wright. Everyone seated at a large table. HAVERSTON
offers a toast.

HAVERSTON

To chaos and annihilation. The old
fashion way. Welcome to the Society
of Killers.

2. THREE FEMALES ON ONE SIDE OF THE TABLE

YAN holds up her large, sharp steak knife.

YAN

Did I mention I'm vegan?

ASTRID

Did I mention I'm a cannibal?

3. THE MALES ON THE OTHER SIDE

QUENTIN stabs his own hand with the steak knife!

QUENTIN
Sorry. I do that when I'm stressed.

BRANDON
What're we having?

PAGE 6 (TWO PANELS)

1. A GROUP OF SERVANTS

Ten SERVANTS in bland white medical-type outfits come in heralding a large platter with an entire barbecued PIG, apple in its mouth. All have glazed looks in their eyes.

HAVERSTON
Our servants. Your servants,
actually. But more on them later.

2. ON PIG

HAVERSTON cuts into the pig. BLOOD flies out and splatters all over the table.

HAVERSTON
Hope you like it rare.

PAGE 7 (THREE PANELS)

1. ON ASTRID RECEIVING A PLATE OF BLOODY PIG MEAT

ASTRID
Could somebody pass the salt?

2. THE THREE GUYS

CYRUS
Nice production so far, Dr.
Haverston.

BRANDON
I'd say you've outdone yourself, but
I have the feeling this is just the
tip of a very, very bloody iceberg.

3. ON HAVERSTON AND KURTZ

KURTZ
You have no idea.

HAVERSTON
Eat up, everyone. Trust me, you'll
need all your strength tomorrow.

PAGE 8 (TWO PANELS)

1. ON WHOLE GROUP AROUND TABLE

CYRUS
You said if we had questions...

SAMARA
Yeah, I have a few...

BRANDON
For instance...

HAVERSTON (O.S.)
STOP!

2. ON HAVERSTON

Has his hand up to silence everyone.

HAVERSTON (CONT'D)
I said I would take your questions.
What I didn't say is that I have no
intention of answering them. With
that I bid you all adieu and
goodnight...

PAGE 9 - FULL PAGE

1. INT. MAIN EXPO ROOM

A 19th century style medical operating theater. HAVERSTON
and KURTZ stand in the center next to a white table with
various knives on display.

All the subjects sit in the front row. Behind them are the
SERVANTS.

HAVERSTON
In the coming days we will cover the
basics of the trade. Motive, victim
selection, planning, execution, and
clean up.

PAGE 10 - FOUR PANELS

1. INT. CLOSE UP ON QUENTIN & BRANDON

QUENTIN
(Whispering aside)
What's with the weirdos behind us in
the cheap seats?

BRANDON
They seem a little off to you?

2. C/U ON HAVERSTON

HAVERSTON
Can we have a volunteer?

3. MEDIUM SHOT AUDIENCE

EVERY SERVANT raises their hands, ecstatic to volunteer.

SERVANTS
Me...me...take me...!

4. ON THE WOMEN SUBJECTS

Reacting

YAN
What's going on...?

ASTRID
I think I know...

PAGE 11-12 (DOUBLE SPLASH- 2x5 PANELS)

1. STAGING AREA IN CENTER OF THEATER

A female SERVANT seems delighted to be picked. Stands in the center in front to KURTZ and HAVERSTON. HAVERSTON caresses her face tenderly.

HAVERSTON
So...motive. What would motivate
you to kill our test subject today?

2. REACTIONS GROUP

CYRUS
She's weak. Defenseless.

BRANDON
Easy mark. Little resistance.

YAN
Because she's pretty. And I want to
use a knife to make her hideous.

QUENTIN

She looks like a screamer. I like screamers.

SAMARA

Because it's Tuesday.

3. HAVERSTON

HAVERSTON

Astrid? We didn't hear from you.

4. ON ASTRID

ASTRID

Teleology 101. The form is defined by it's outcome, not its purpose or motive. I kill simple because I wish to, and because I can.

5. ON KURTZ AND HAVERSTON

KURTZ

You were right. She is special.

HAVERSTON

(Holding up a HUGE
knife)

Okay, Astrid. Show me.

PAGE 13 (FULL PAGE 5 PANELS)

1. WIDER SHOT STAGING AREA

ASTRID stands in front of the SERVANT with the knife placed right in her face.

ASTRID

You ready, sweet thing?

2. REACTIONS SUBJECTS

CRYUS

Whoa, wait...you mean really kill her?

QUENTIN

Fuckin' rad, dude.

3. HAVERSTON

HAVERSTON

You hardly expected us to train you to kill without a fresh supply of victims, did you?

4. ON SAMARA & YAN

SAMARA
She won't resist?

YAN
Isn't she afraid?

5. CLOSE ON SERVANT

She looks elated, so happy as ASTRID is about to slit her throat.

HAVERSTON (O.S.)
The ultimate human dignity lays in
acknowledging what you truly are:
That you will never be a predator,
only the prey.

SERVANT VICTIM
Miss St. James, thank you, it is
such an honor to die for you today.

PAGE 14 (FULL PAGE 4 PANELS)

1. WIDER SHOT STAGING AREA - CONTINUOUS

SLASH! ASTRID cuts the SERVANT's through. Blood splatters everywhere.

2. C/U SERVANT on the floor, bleeding out, HUGE SMILE on her face, eyes wide open.

NOTE TO ANDREA: Have blood spill down from this panel to the ones below...

3. REACTION SERVANTS

They all cheer in unison!

4. REACTIONS SUBJECTS

Eyes wide open, entranced...

QUENTIN
God I fucking love this place...

YAN
Can I go next?!

PAGE 15 (FULL PAGE 4 PANELS - one large on top, three small bottom)

1. SOCIAL MEETING AREA

A nicely appointed library-type atmosphere meeting area. Servants serve champagne in flutes off trays. HAVERSTON looks at his watch and says...

HAVERSTON

Happy hour is only 30 minutes.
Lockdown is at 8. Be careful with
your words; everything you say and
do is being recorded.

2. YAN & SAMARA chat next to a stack of books. BRANDON thumbs through SILENCE OF THE LAMBS. Other titles include MASK OF SANITY and several other titles featuring the words SERIAL KILLER, PSYCHOPATH, etc.

SAMARA

(Off the book)
How on brand, right?

YAN

I guess, if you're into that theme
park bullshit.

3. QUENTIN and BRANDON chat next to the fireplace.

QUENTIN

So how many bodybags you racked up
in your career, Prince Charming?

BRANDON

A gentleman doesn't kill and tell.

4. CYRUS offers ASTRID a drink.

CRYUS

You giving everybody the silence
treatment is getting old.

ASTRID

I know where your mother lives.

PAGE 16 (FULL PAGE 4 PANELS)

1. NEXT TO COCKTAIL BAR

SAMARA talks to KURTZ.

SAMARA

So how'd you get into this line of
work, Dr. Kurtz?

KURTZ
Remember the Silver Lake Killer? 24
confirmed kills. Only one person
survived...

SAMARA
So you're...

KURTZ
The Silver Lake Killer, yeah. But I
don't like to brag.

2. WIDER SHOT - QUENTIN & CYRUS join the chat with KURTZ.

CYRUS
What about Haverston? What's his
kill count?

KURTZ
Oh he doesn't bother killing people.
He trains psychos like you to do it
for him.

QUENTIN
Man I can't wait to get out of here
and start killing.

KURTZ
Who says you're ever getting out of
here?

3. ASTRID and YAN

YAN
Let me guess: Victim of incest, MAOA
gene, pathological hatred of men?

ASTRID
Pathological hatred of everyone,
actually. Especially narcissistic
mass-murder wanna'-be's like you.

4. ON SECURITY GUARDS

As bell rings.

SECURITY GUARD #1
Structured social time is now
complete. You will now proceed to
your assigned areas.

PAGE 17 (FULL PAGE 5 PANELS)

1. HALLWAY LIVING QUARTERS - MOMENTS LATER

Each security guard escorts each subject to their rooms. A red LCD counts down the minutes and seconds.

SECURITY GUARD #2
Lockdown in T-Minus 10.

2. YAN stands next to her door with SECURITY GUARD #1.

YAN
Wanna' eat Chinese tonight? Oh wait,
I'm not supposed to fuck you.

3. C/U ON GUARD

SECURITY GUARD #1
Oh you can fuck me, just not kill
me.

4. ON YAN and GUARD as she gestures for him to enter.

YAN
Chop chop, then. Only have ten
minutes.

SECURITY GUARD #1
I can do a lot of damage in ten
minutes.

PAGE 18 (FULL PAGE 1 PANELS)

1. INSIDE YAN's ROOM

YAN's hands are tied behind her back, splayed on the bed naked, ass in the air, as SECURITY GUARD unbuckles his pants behind her.

SECURITY GUARD #1 (CONT'D)
How does it feel with the shoe on
the other foot, dragon lady?

YAN
I did come here to learn, right?

SECURITY GUARD #1
Then get ready for a tough lesson.

PAGE 19-20 (DOUBLE SPLASH- 5 PANELS)

1. ULTRA HIGH TECH LABORATORY - HIGH CEILINGS - VAST

MRI machines, CAT/PET scanners, monitors, wires everywhere. HAVERSTON speaks to the subjects standing next to a specially outfitted HOSPITAL BED.

HAVERSTON

We return to the topic of motive.
Anyone can claim to be or act like a
psychopath. This machine will
ascertain your true neurological
capacity to kill. Who would like to
go first?

2. ON THE SUBJECTS

QUENTIN's hand is up.

3. OVERHEAD SHOT QUENTIN STRAPPED ONTO THE BED

Multiple electrodes attached to his head. Sunglasses-sized
VR goggles. KURTZ holds up a HUGE syringe in her hand.

KURTZ

We will use quantum computer
simulations AI for you to enter a
virtual predator-prey scenario, and
see how well you choose, stalk,
entrap, and dispatch your victim.

QUENTIN

Hell yeah. Jack me into the fuckin'
matrix, doc.

4. HAVERSTON NEXT TO 8 HUGE COMPUTER SCREENS RUNNING
DIAGNOSTICS, etc.

HAVERSTON

Dr. Kurtz, the dissociative serum
and paralysis drug, please.

5. C/U ON QUENTIN

Excited as the needle PLUNGES into his vein.

**PAGE 21 (FULL PAGE 6 PANELS - LEFT PANELS VR WORLD / RIGHT
PANELS REAL WORLD)**

1. VR WORLD PARKING LOT - NIGHT

A pretty YOUNG WOMAN walks to her car in a dark garage. Off
to the right foreground watching her is QUENTIN, well dressed
in suit and tie, standing next to a Mercedes.

2. REAL WORLD LAB ON HAVERSTON PRESSING BUTTONS ON HIS
CONTROLS

As the other subject watch QUENTIN's POV of the VR-rendered
world on a TV screen, as well as BRAIN SCANS, HEART MONITORS.

HAVERSTON
A woman walking alone to her car
after work. Simple. Or so it seems.

3. VR WORLD PARKING LOT

QUENTIN approaches the woman.

QUENTIN
It's kind of late, miss. Want me to
walk you to your car?

WOMAN
Uh...sure...I guess...thank you...

4. REAL WORLD LAB

HAVERSTON and the group look at a BRAIN SCAN with heat
signatures of various colors, and QUENTIN's VR POV.

KURTZ opines...

KURTZ
Amygdala relays to his periaqueductal
grey are off the charts.

HAVERSTON
Nominal. He senses an easy kill.

5. VR WORLD

QUENTIN and the WOMAN walk towards her car. He is now carrying
a large glimmering KNIFE behind his back.

QUENTIN
You can never be too careful. Crazy
people out there.

WOMAN
Tell me about it.

6. REAL WORLD LAB

C/U of HAVERSTON pressing a big RED BUTTON.

HAVERSTON (O.S.)
But not everything is as simple as
it seems.

**PAGE 22 (FULL PAGE 4 PANELS - LEFT PANELS VR WORLD / RIGHT
PANELS REAL WORLD)**

1. VR WORLD

The dark parking lot is now a SUNNY WALMART PARKING LOT. The WOMAN pushes a shopping cart. QUENTIN seems a bit rattled by the scene change.

QUENTIN
What the...

WOMAN
My car's just over here...

2. REAL WORLD LAB

Everyone watches QUENTIN's POV cam, and the various brain scan displays.

HAVERSTON
Rostral anterior cingulate cortex
registers less electrical potential.

SAMARA
That bad?

KURTZ
Ain't good. Means he's hesitating.

3. VR WORLD

QUENTIN and the WOMAN at the car, its passenger door open and a 10 year old girl smiles ear-to-ear.

GIRL
Hi mommie, what took you so long?
Who's your friend?

4. REAL WORLD LAB

The scanners go haywire and light up with increased brain activity.

HAVERSTON
Let's see how Mr. Larouche's
motivation to kill is affected by
this change in the moral calculus.

PAGE 23 (FULL PAGE 3 PANELS)

1. VR WORLD

C/U on QUENTIN as he seems confused, anxious.

QUENTIN
Sorry...I was just...just walking
your mommie to her car...

2. REAL WORLD

HAVERSTON et al all look at the brain scans etc. All the red brain regions have turned blue.

HAVERSTON
Observations?

SAMARA
The little girl made him...care.

BRANDON
Even worse, sympathetic.

ASTRID
Ugh, how pedestrian.

CYRUS
All that bluster was complete
bullshit.

YAN
I knew he was a poser.

HAVERSTON
Terminating the simulation.

3. REAL WORLD

QUENTIN screaming in the frustration of failure as he comes out of the VR simulation, tries to break out of confinement. HAVERSTON, KURTZ and the other subjects stand all around him.

QUENTIN
Fuck! You fucking tricked me!!

HAVERSTON
Guards take him away.

PAGE 24 (FULL PAGE 3 PANELS)

1. LAB

Four guards wheel QUENTIN away, still strapped to the bed, now a GAG on his mouth as he writhes in anger.

SAMARA
Where you taking him?

HAVERSTON
The Servants need a little hands-on
practice too.

2. REC ROOM

A large room. The SERVANTS all look eager and happy as they huddle around a table covered in all kinds of knives and

daggers. The GUARDS have placed the BED with QUENTIN upright against a far wall. KURTZ stands with a clipboard.

KURTZ

You may begin...

3. ROOM OUTSIDE REC ROOM

HAVERSTON and all the remaining subjects watch as all the SERVANTS attack a helpless QUENTIN with knives. Blood sprays everywhere. QUENTIN looks terrified.

HAVERSTON

Let this be a lesson to all of you.
Motivation can NEVER be compromised
by emotion.

ASTRID

Moving right along, anybody hungry...?

PAGE 25-26 (DOUBLE SPLASH) - THREE PANELS

1. INT. DINING ROOM

Everyone sits for dinner. Sober vibe. Empty chair where QUENTIN once was.

SAMARA

What's for dinner?

BRANDON

Better yet, *who's* for dinner?

2. REVERSE SHOT

Servants, with their white outfits still splattered with blood, carry in trays of PHEASANT & TURKEY, etc.

HAVERSTON stands behind ASTRID with his hands on her shoulders.

ASTRID

What a shame. I thought we were
going full Hannibal Lecter.

HAVERSTON

You'd like us all to believe your
psychopathy is unshakeable. Let's
see, shall we?

3. CLOSER ON ASTRID and HAVERSTON

SERVANT places a plate with QUENTIN's HEAD ON IT, garnished with mashed potatoes, carrots, etc.

ASTRID is emotion-less. While the other subjects in the foreground look amazed.

HAVERSTON (CONT'D)

What say you, Miss St. James?

ASTRID

I say...pass the salt.